

Antitrust Notice

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2025

ANNUAL MEETING

Where Risk Innovation
Sparks Creation

AUSTIN
TEXAS
NOVEMBER
9-12 2025



Actuarial Review's Latest Hits

Presented by CAS Fellows

DJ Falkson, Rob Kahn, and Sara Chen



Learning Objectives



- Rob Kahn, FCAS
 - Contrast industry wildfire experience before and after the late 2010s.
 - Life. The World. The Universe ... and California Wildfires



Learning Objectives



- DJ Falkson, FCAS
 - Explain past and potential future effects of zoning laws and urban development patterns on different P&C lines of insurance.
 - Navigating New Urban Realities: Zoning, Housing Affordability and Insurance



Learning Objectives



- Sara Chen, FCAS
 - Have a better understanding of industry news from the past six months and how it affects actuaries today.
 - Developing News



Pricing California Wildfire Risks

An Abbreviated History of CA Wildfire Pricing

Rob Kahn, FCAS

Eras to Explore

- Pre - 2017
- 2017 – 2024
 - Camp
- 2025 and Beyond
- Summary



Pricing CA Wildfires – Pre 2017

Homeowner Rate Filings in CA

- Catastrophe Analysis: Exhibit 9
- Actual Losses split: non-Cat vs Cat
- Cat Load: Total Loss / Non-Cat Loss
- Cat Loss Percent
 - = $1.0 - 1 / \text{Cat Load}$
 - = $1.0 - \text{Non-Cat Loss} / \text{Total Loss}$

(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
Accident Year	Non-Cat Paid Loss	Cat Paid Loss	Total Paid Loss	Total/Non-Cat
1988	\$77,023,067	\$19,055,078	\$96,078,145	1.25
1989	\$85,048,149	\$4,426,849	\$89,474,998	1.05
1990	\$103,456,892	\$54,636,319	\$158,093,211	1.53
1991	\$123,570,588	\$114,598,868	\$238,169,456	1.93
1992	\$129,972,786	\$9,874,359	\$139,847,145	1.08
1993	\$154,987,825	\$115,658,054	\$270,645,879	1.75
1994	\$172,357,542	\$0	\$172,357,542	1.00
1995	\$190,817,481	\$99,672,176	\$290,489,657	1.52
1996	\$164,858,517	\$9,184,409	\$174,042,926	1.06
1997	\$197,566,987	\$3,814,598	\$201,381,585	1.02
1998	\$232,595,364	\$17,432,743	\$250,028,107	1.07
1999	\$264,255,534	\$0	\$264,255,534	1.00
2000	\$346,747,301	\$0	\$346,747,301	1.00
2001	\$337,606,253	\$0	\$337,606,253	1.00
2002	\$253,105,832	\$9,934,321	\$263,040,153	1.04
2003	\$171,834,909	\$255,738,308	\$427,573,217	2.49
2004	\$167,822,351	\$2,681,109	\$170,503,460	1.02
2005	\$174,076,266	\$7,075,099	\$181,151,365	1.04
2006	\$215,871,408	\$6,153,950	\$222,025,358	1.03
2007	\$274,738,225	\$230,739,663	\$505,477,888	1.84
2008	\$333,887,621	\$27,331,497	\$361,219,118	1.08
2009	\$282,093,154	\$0	\$282,093,154	1.00
2010	\$276,657,326	\$14,544,762	\$291,202,088	1.05
2011	\$299,969,852	\$20,344,404	\$320,314,256	1.07
2012	\$338,329,552	\$22,203	\$338,351,755	1.00
2013	\$373,593,380	\$3,837,682	\$377,431,062	1.01
2014	\$348,688,470	\$9,405,706	\$358,094,176	1.03
2015	\$278,056,853	\$108,167,663	\$386,224,516	1.39
Total:	\$6,369,589,485	\$1,144,329,820	\$7,513,919,305	1.18
28 Year Average				1.23



Pricing CA Wildfires – Pre 2017

= [(3) - 1.0] /					
(3)					
= (4) x (5)					
(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
Carrier	Disposition Date	Prior Cat Load	Prior Cat %	Prior Cred Wtd. Pure Premium	Prior Cat Load (\$)
Allstate Insurance Group	10/29/2018	1.349	26%	\$689	\$178
California State Auto Group	6/16/2017	1.256	20%	\$713	\$145
Farmers	3/28/2017	1.216	18%	\$703	\$125
Nationwide Mutual Insurance Company	9/6/2018	1.171	15%	\$795	\$116
Safeco Insurance Companies	1/6/2017	1.238	19%	\$766	\$147
State Farm General Insurance Company	6/15/2018	1.268	21%	\$733	\$155
USAA Casualty	9/20/2017	1.352	26%	\$1,055	\$275
Median:		1.256	20%	\$733	\$149

Cat Load circa 2017: ~1.25 (~20% of Total Expected Loss is from Catastrophes)
 → ~\$150 of expected Cat Loss per House Year



Pricing CA Wildfires – Pre 2017

CDI File # (Department Use Only):

VARIANCE - NONE

RATE CHANGE CALCULATION

Completed by: Shina Fritz
 Date Completed: 5/17/2016
 Prior Effective Date: 8/11/2015
 Proposed Effective Date: 10/25/2016
 Detailed Line Description: Homeowners Multiple Peril
 Coverage: Next Generation® Homeowners

Data Provided by Filer	20134	20144	20154	Projected
Prem_Written			951,154,127	951,154,127
Prem_Earned			955,802,190	955,802,190
Prem_Adj			1.067	
Prem_Trend			0.980	-0.9%
Misc_Fees			6,386,358	6,386,358
Exposures_Earned			935,724	935,724
Losses			345,201,678	345,201,678
DCCE			2,962,431	2,962,431
Loss_Devt			1.317	
DCCE_Devt			5.133	
Loss_Trend			1.151	6.3%
DCCE_Trend			1.151	6.3%
CAT_Adj			1.216	
Anc_Income			2,045,387	2,045,387

Calculations	20134	20144	20154
Prem_Adjusted			1,006,471,656
Losses_Adjusted			636,146,774
DCCE_Adjusted			21,286,503
LossDCCERatio_Adjusted			65.3%
TCRLP_perExp			1,075.61
LossDCCE_perExp			702.59
CompLossDCCE_perExp			672.72
CredLoss_perExp			702.59
Anc_Inc_perExp			2.19

Farmers Example circa 2016: ~ 1.22 ($0.216/1.216 = \sim 18\%$ of total is Cat)
 $\rightarrow \sim \$125$ of expected Cat Loss per House Year ($= \sim \$703 \times 18\%$)



Pricing CA Wildfires – 2017 - 2024

What happened since 2017?



Pricing CA Wildfires – 2017 - 2024

Top 20 Most Destructive CA Wildfires through 2023

FIRE NAME (CAUSE)	DATE	COUNTY	STRUCTURES DESTROYED	RANK
CALDOR(Under Investigation)	Sep 2021	Alpine, Amador, & El Dorado	1,003	16
DIXIE (Powerlines)	Jul 2021	Butte, Plumas, Lassen, & Tehama	1,311	14
GLASS (Undetermined)	Sep 2020	Napa & Sonoma	1,520	10
NORTH COMPLEX (Lightning)	Aug 2020	Butte, Plumas, & Yuba	2,352	5
LNU LIGHTNING COMPLEX(Lightning/Arson)	Aug 2020	Napa, Solano, Sonoma, Yolo,Lake, & Colusa	1,491	11
CZU LIGHTNING COMPLEX (Lightning)	Aug 2020	Santa Cruz, San Mateo	1,490	12
AUGUST COMPLEX (Lightning)	Aug 2020	Mendocino, Humboldt, Trinity, Tehama,Glenn, Lake, & Colusa	935	19
CAMP (Powerlines)	Nov 2018	Butte	18,804	1
WOOLSEY (Electrical)	Nov 2018	Ventura	1,643	8
CARR (Human Related)	Jul 2018	Shasta County, Trinity	1,614	9
THOMAS (Powerlines)	Dec 2017	Ventura & Santa Barbara	1,063	15
TUBBS (Electrical)	Oct 2017	Napa & Sonoma	5,636	2
NUNS (Powerlines)	Oct 2017	Sonoma	1,355	13
VALLEY (Electrical)	Sep 2015	Lake, Napa & Sonoma	1,955	6
BUTTE (Powerlines)	Sep 2015	Amador & Calaveras	921	20
WITCH (Powerlines)	Oct 2007	San Diego	1,650	7
CEDAR (Human Related)	Oct 2003	San Diego	2,820	4
OLD (Human Related)	Oct 2003	San Bernardino	1,003	16
JONES (Undetermined)	Oct 1999	Shasta	954	18
TUNNEL - Oakland Hills (Rekindle)	Oct 1991	Alameda	2,900	3

4 Years

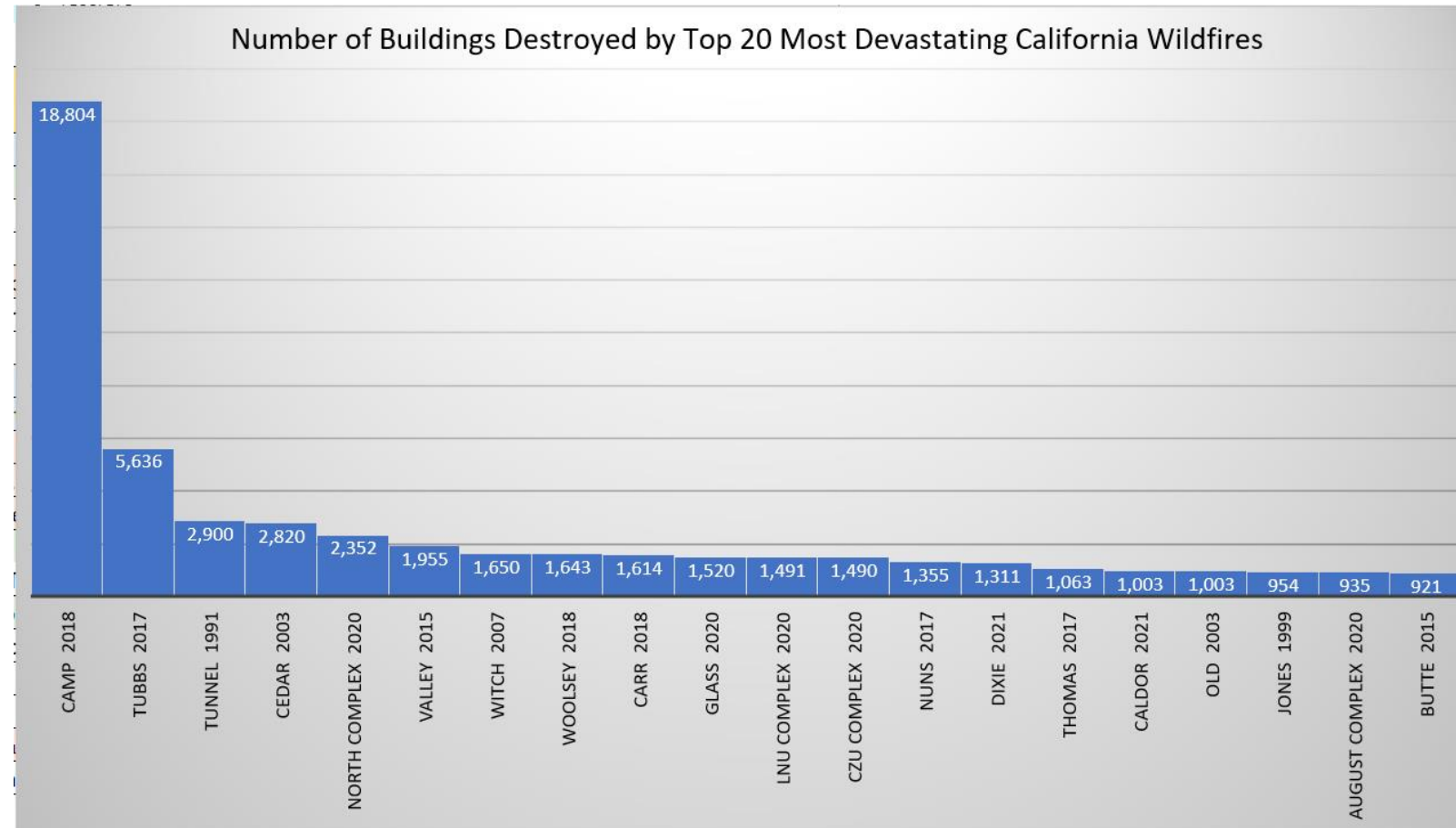
25 Years



Pricing CA Wildfires – 2017 - 2024

Camp Wildfire (2018)
extreme outlier

12 of Top 16 most
destructive wildfires
2017 and later



Pricing CA Wildfires – 2017 - 2024

(1) Accident Year	(2) Non-Cat Paid Loss	(3) Cat Paid Loss	(4) Total Paid Loss	(5) Total/ Non-Cat
1988	\$77,023,067	\$19,055,078	\$96,078,145	1.25
1989	\$85,048,149	\$4,426,849	\$89,474,998	1.05
1990	\$103,456,892	\$54,636,319	\$158,093,211	1.53
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1992	\$129,972,786	\$9,874,359	\$139,847,145	1.08
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1994	\$172,357,542	\$0	\$172,357,542	1.00
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1996	\$164,858,517	\$9,184,409	\$174,042,926	1.06
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2000	\$346,747,301	\$0	\$346,747,301	1.00
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2002	\$253,105,832	\$9,934,321	\$263,040,153	1.04
2003	\$171,834,909	\$255,738,308	\$427,573,217	2.49
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2008	\$333,887,621	\$27,331,497	\$361,219,118	1.08
2009	\$282,093,154	\$0	\$282,093,154	1.00
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2011	\$299,969,852	\$20,344,404	\$320,314,256	1.07
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2015	\$278,056,853	\$108,167,663	\$386,224,516	1.39
Total:	\$6,369,589,485	\$1,144,329,820	\$7,513,919,305	1.18
28 Year Average				1.23

Comparison of 2016 vs 2024 Farmers Exhibit 9

(1) Accident Year	(2) Non-Cat Paid Loss	(3) Cat Paid Loss	(4) Total Paid Loss	(5) Total/ Non-Cat
20043	\$163,458,551	\$248,732,000	\$412,190,551	2.52
20053	\$169,341,155	\$7,767,150	\$177,108,305	1.05
20063	\$191,512,568	\$9,563,102	\$201,075,670	1.05
20073	\$274,859,168	\$9,677,974	\$284,537,142	1.04
20083	\$278,495,623	\$242,445,905	\$520,941,528	1.87
20093	\$326,671,223	\$0	\$326,671,223	1.00
20103	\$273,643,781	\$9,007,777	\$282,651,558	1.03
20113	\$292,437,938	\$5,675,474	\$298,113,412	1.02
20123	\$310,287,185	\$20,391,100	\$330,678,285	1.07
20133	\$363,990,252	\$3,838,017	\$367,828,269	1.01
20143	\$364,742,803	\$0	\$364,742,803	1.00
20153	\$362,568,339	\$131,516,800	\$494,085,139	1.36
20163	\$403,974,748	\$14,476,663	\$418,451,411	1.04
20173	\$405,953,476	\$24,870,709	\$430,824,185	1.06
20183	\$341,307,955	\$846,794,306	\$1,188,102,261	3.48
20193	\$370,428,929	\$527,328,757	\$897,757,686	2.42
20203	\$344,838,185	\$340,318,212	\$685,156,397	1.99
20213	\$387,361,409	\$119,773,360	\$507,134,769	1.31
20223	\$419,848,152	\$12,193,265	\$432,041,417	1.03
20233	\$365,656,278	\$67,537,566	\$433,193,844	1.18
Total:	\$6,411,377,718	\$2,641,908,137	\$9,053,285,855	1.41
20 Year Average				1.43

$$0.20/1.20 = 16.7\%$$

$$0.40/1.40 = 28.6\%$$



Pricing CA Wildfires – 2017 - 2024

$$= [(3) - 1.0] / (3) = (4) \times (5)$$

(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
Carrier	Disposition Date	Current Cat Load	Current Cat %	Current Cred Wtd. Pure Premium	Current Cat Load (\$)
Allstate Insurance Group	8/8/2024	1.279	22%	\$1,395	\$304
California State Auto Group	P	1.600	38%	\$1,407	\$528
Farmers	6/12/2024	1.418	29%	\$1,864	\$549
Nationwide Mutual Insurance Company	9/15/2023	1.430	30%	\$1,193	\$359
Safeco Insurance Companies	P	1.327	25%	\$2,056	\$507
State Farm General Insurance Company	12/22/2023	1.366	27%	\$1,542	\$413
USAA Casualty	P	1.246	20%	\$2,039	\$403
Median:		1.366	27%	\$1,542	\$413

Cat Load circa 2024: ~1.37 (~27% of total is Cat)

→ ~\$400 - \$500 of expected Cat Loss per House Year (Nearly triple the 2017 value)



Pricing CA Wildfires – 2025 and Beyond

Starting in 2025, insurers may rely upon Catastrophe models (**w/ restrictions**):
[Catastrophe-Modeling-and-Ratemaking-Final-Text-of-Regulation.PDF](#)

Adopt Section 2644.4.5. Use of Catastrophe Models.

(a) Permitted uses.

- (1) For the earthquake and flood lines, projected annual aggregate losses may be based on catastrophe models.
- (2) The catastrophe adjustment for the fire following earthquake exposure, and for terrorism exposure, in lines other than earthquake and flood may be based on projected annual aggregate losses derived from catastrophe models.

(b) Wildfire exposure.

The catastrophe adjustment for wildfire exposure for commercial property insurance may be based on catastrophe models, provided that the insurer complies with the provisions of Section 2644.4.8 that are applicable to commercial property insurance. The catastrophe adjustment for wildfire exposure for “qualifying residential property insurance,” as that term is defined in Section 2644.4.8, may be based on catastrophe models, provided that the insurer complies with the provisions of Section 2644.4.8 that are applicable to such qualifying residential property insurance. For an insurer that thus complies with Section 2644.4.8 with respect to such qualifying residential property insurance, the catastrophe adjustment for wildfire exposure covered under a renter’s insurance policy, an HO-6 policy, or the equivalent of an HO-6 policy, may also be based on catastrophe models.

(e) Catastrophe models shall be run on the insurer’s in-force business as of the end of the most recent year in the recorded period.

(f) The use of catastrophe models shall conform to the standards of practice as set forth by the Actuarial Standards Board, and the applicant shall have the burden of demonstrating that:

- (1) the model is based upon what in the Commissioner’s assessment is the best available scientific information for assessing frequency, severity, damage and loss,
- (2) the applicant’s use of its selected model(s) produces the most actuarially sound estimate of projected catastrophe losses,
- (3) the projected losses derived from the model meet all applicable statutory, regulatory and other legal standards, and
- (4) the model incorporates what in the Commissioner’s assessment is the best available scientific information on risk mitigation at the property, community, and landscape scales including, but not limited to forest management, prescribed fire, nature-based flood risk reduction, and risk mitigation initiated by local and regional utility companies.



Pricing CA Wildfires – 2025 and Beyond

There is a 92-page checklist to aid applicants in filing their inaugural wildfire models:

- [Wildfire Catastrophe Model Checklist](#)

Form G-5: Actuarial Guidelines Expert Certification

Purpose: This form identifies the signatory or signatories who have reviewed the current submission for compliance with the Actuarial Guidelines (A-1 to A-6) in accordance with the stated provisions.

I hereby certify that I have reviewed the current submission of (Insert Name of Wildfire Catastrophe Model) _____ Version (Insert Version) _____ for compliance with the Actuarial Guidelines for Wildfire Catastrophe Models adopted by the California Department of Insurance and hereby certify that:

1. The wildfire catastrophe model meets the Actuarial Guidelines (A-1 to A-6);
2. The disclosures and forms related to the Actuarial Guidelines section are editorially and technically accurate, reliable, unbiased, and complete;
3. My review was completed in accordance with the Actuarial Standards of Practice and Code of Conduct; and
4. In expressing my opinion, I have not been influenced by any other party in order to bias or prejudice my opinion.

Name

Professional Credentials (Area of Expertise)

Signature (final submission)

Date



Pricing CA Wildfires – 2025 and Beyond

Starting in 2025, insurers may now pass reinsurance costs into premiums

- [Reinsurance Legislation](#)

(d) Notwithstanding subdivision (c), the Commissioner shall permit consideration for the cost or benefits of reinsurance according to subdivision (b) of 2644.25.1.

NOTE : Authority cited: Sections 1861.01 and 1861.05, Insurance Code; and *20th Century v. Garamendi*, 8 Cal.4th 216 (1994). Reference: Sections 1861.01 and 1861.05, Insurance Code; and *Calfarm Insurance Company v. Deukmejian* (1989) 48 Cal.3d 805.

Amend: Section 2644.25. **Reinsurance**

(a) For all lines and sublines except for those listed in the next subparagraph, and the catastrophe perils within the property lines listed in subdivision (b) of section 2644.25.1, ratemaking shall be on a direct basis, with no consideration for the cost or benefits of reinsurance.



Pricing CA Wildfires – Summary

Before 2017

Wildfire Peril ~20% of total expected HO loss in CA. (~\$150/home)

Between 2017 and the present, multiple LARGE wildfires

Recent estimates:

Wildfire Peril ~25% - 30% of total expected HO loss in CA. (~\$450/home)

2025:

Wildfire Models and Reinsurance Costs now allowed



Zoning, Risk, and the Shape of Insurance

How (sub)urban rules move growth and losses across P&C lines

AR Greatest Hits
DJ Falkson, FCAS

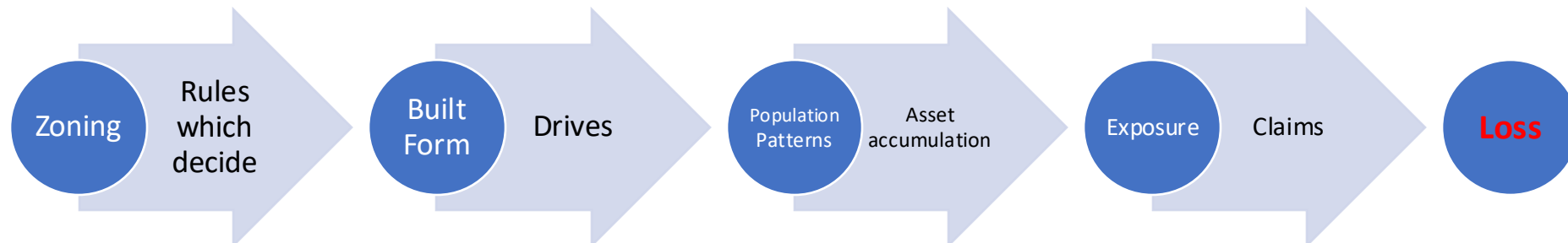




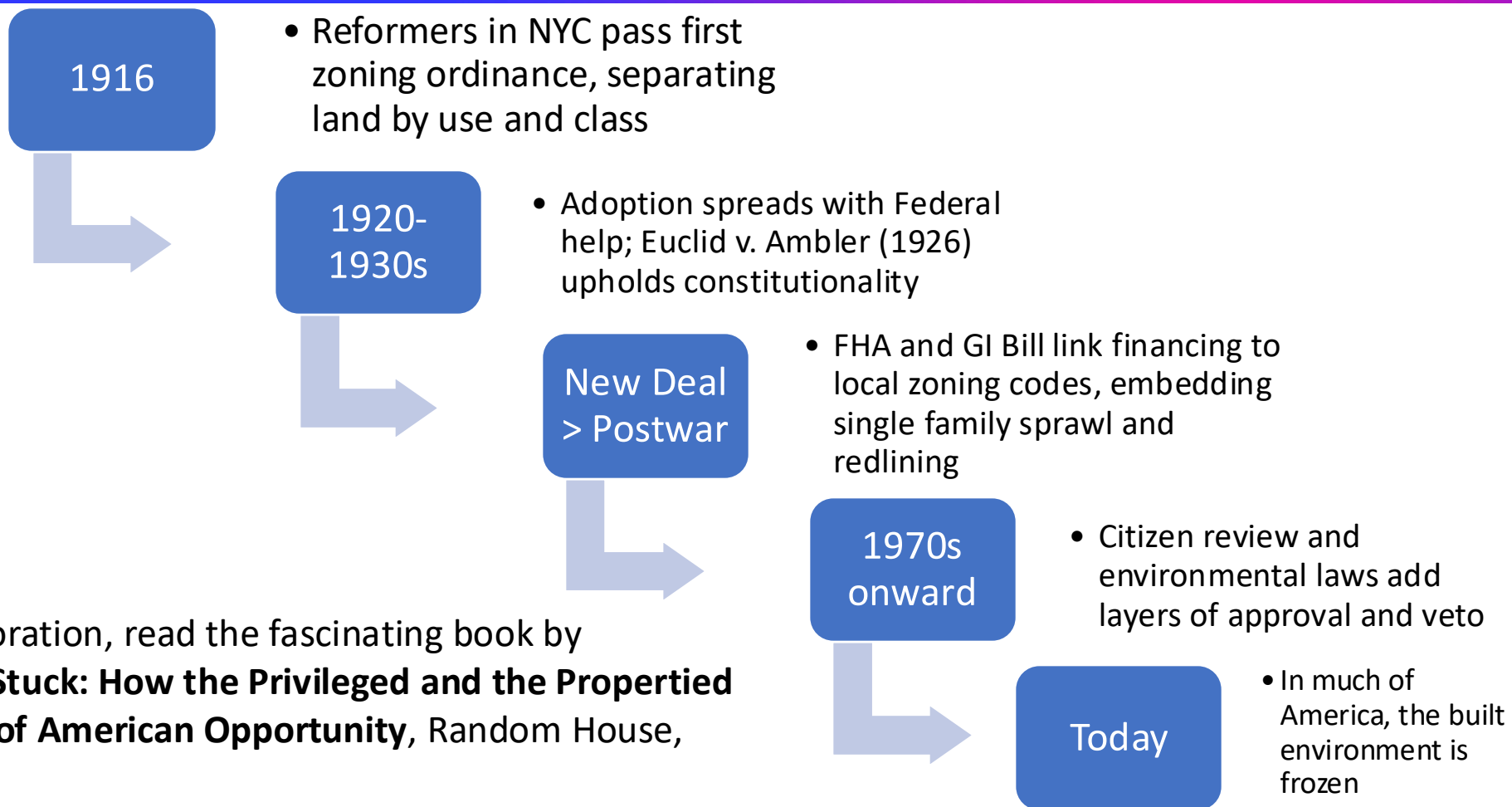
Why Zoning Matters for Insurance

Zoning is the set of local laws that dictate how land can be used—what can be built where, how tall or dense it can be, and what activities are allowed on each parcel.

- Determines **what gets built and where people live**
- These choices create **different exposure patterns**—to wildfire, flood, hail, more/less driving
- For insurers, zoning operates **upstream of loss data**



A Century of Zoning in 60 Seconds



For a deeper exploration, read the fascinating book by Yoni Appelbaum, **Stuck: How the Privileged and the Propertied Broke the Engine of American Opportunity**, Random House, 2025



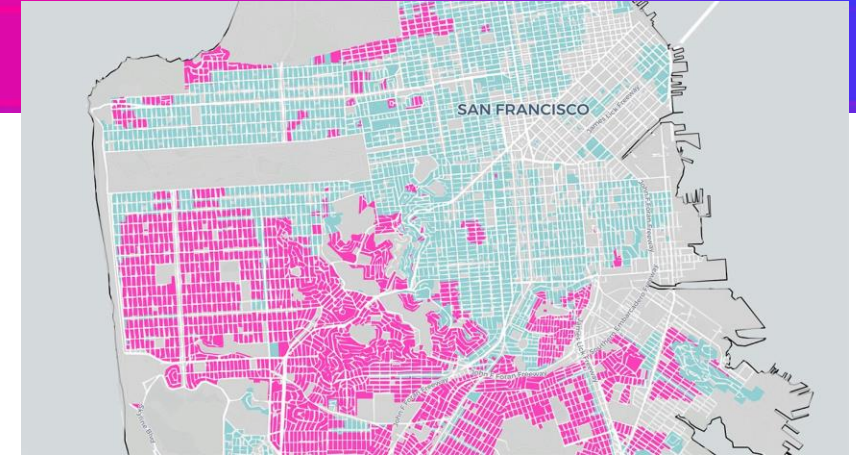
How Zoning Codes Restrict Growth

- **Single-family-only zones** ban duplexes and small apartments across most land
- **Minimum lot sizes** ensure low density and high per-unit land cost
- **Parking minimums** inflate construction cost and use excessive space
- **Height/Floor Area Ratio limits** throttle infill even where demand is strongest.



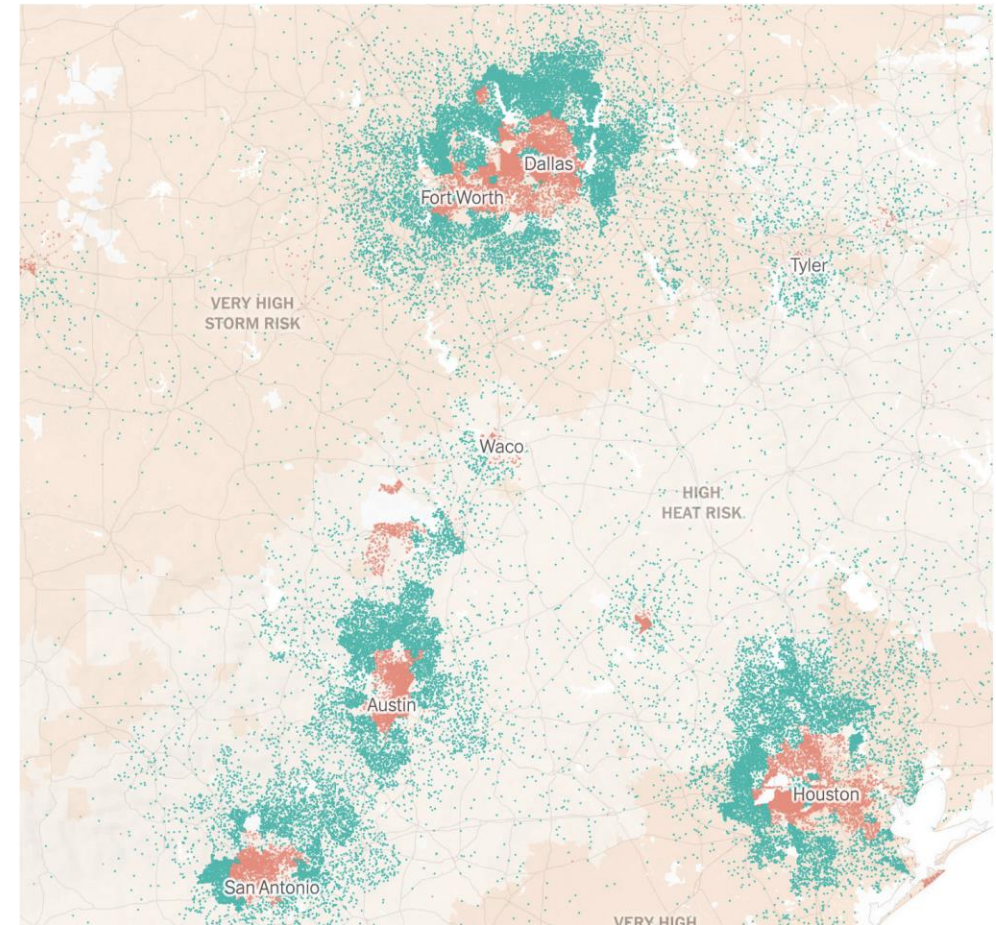
Case Study: California Wildfire

- **Restrictive urban zoning and environmental review laws** (e.g. California Environmental Quality Act CEQA) limited infill development in safer, denser cores
- **Housing pressure spilled outward**: since the 1990s, nearly **1.5 million new homes** have been built in the **wildland–urban interface (WUI)**
- **Artificially low insurance premiums** and suppressed rate filings (Prop 103) distorted risk signals, encouraging development in fire-prone areas
- **Suburban design**—cul-de-sacs, wood-frame construction, adjacency to unmanaged vegetation—**magnifies exposure and loss severity**
- **Denser, mixed-use urban cores** (walkable grids, masonry construction, shared walls) are **inherently more fire-resilient**, yet often illegal to build. Existing stock increasingly expensive to rent/buy as demand outstrips supply.



Case Study: Severe Convective Storm (SCS)

- Stronger, costlier **severe convective storms** across Texas & the Midwest
- **Sprawl = exposure:** big roofs, wide lots, parked cars → higher losses
- **Migration from high-cost coasts** fuels southern sprawl & risk
- Can pro-housing reform also **reduce catastrophe exposure?**



Urban Reform Snapshot

Reform / Policy	Location / Year	What It Does
CEQA Reform & SB 79 TOD	California (passed 2025)	Exempts infill housing near transit from full CEQA review; mandates higher density within transit-oriented districts.
Austin HOME Initiative	Austin, TX (2023 – 2024)	Allows up to 3 units per lot, cuts minimum lot sizes, and simplifies approvals for “missing middle” housing.
Texas HB 24 & SB 15	Texas (2025)	Streamlines zoning, limits neighborhood vetoes, and legalizes smaller homes on smaller lots statewide.
Minneapolis 2040 Plan	Minneapolis, MN (2018 +)	Ends single-family-only zoning, allowing duplexes and triplexes citywide; adds transit-corridor density.
City of Yes (Housing Opportunity)	New York City (2024)	Modernizes zoning code to allow office-to-residential conversions, reduce parking minimums, and unlock small-scale infill.



Insurance Implications of Zoning Reform

Line of Business	Zoning / Urban Development Effects	Direction of Change (all else equal!)
Property	Infill reduces exposure to wildfire / hail; newer housing stock = stronger codes, better materials	↓ Frequency / Severity
Homeowners / Renters	Shift from single-family to multi-family; more renters, condos, small landlords	Mix shift → new product needs
Auto	Density lowers car ownership & miles driven; sprawl inflates vehicle exposure	↓ Frequency (urban), ↑ Severity (sprawl)
Commercial	Rise of mixed-use, maker spaces, and small retail under housing	↑ Demand for tailored package policies
Construction / Builders' Risk	Eased permitting → more projects, infill construction	↑ Demand for builders' risk & contractor liability
Micromobility & Transit	E-bikes, scooters, expanded public transit systems	New coverage niches emerging
Climate & Resilience	Dense, walkable development reduces emissions and exposure concentration	Long-term ↓ systemic risk, ↑ transitional risk



For the Modelers: Built Environment Signals?

Feature	Data Source	Example Metric / Use Case
Zoning regulation	National Zoning Atlas	Max FAR, permitted uses, setback limits
Regulatory friction	Wharton Residential Land Use Regulatory Index (WRLURI)	Land-use restrictiveness score for metro areas
Urbanity & commuting	RUCA (Rural-Urban Commuting Area) codes	Tract-level rural/urban classification
Built environment	EPA Smart Location Mapping	Density, job access, walkability, transit indicators
Land cover	National Land Cover Database (NLCD)	Percent impervious surface, canopy, land use change



Actuarial Review Plug

- Explore ideas at the crossroads of insurance, policy, and society
- Writing builds clarity, confidence, and follow-through
- Deadlines force creative discipline
- Connect ideas across disciplines — a timeless skill, even in the AI era
- A supportive, collaborative writing group
- Builds your network, your brand, your voice

actuarialREVIEW



What is Developing News?

- Actuarial Review's newest column
- Bite-sized reads
- Each Developing News article features:
 - A summary of the news story
 - Implications for actuaries and the insurance industry



News Topic: AI

Putting the AI in NAIC – Erin Lachen



Artificial Intelligence Gone Nuclear – Jim Weiss



Agentic AI: Your New Actuarial Coworker – Xuan You



GenAI Related Litigation Brings Fair Use into Focus – Jim Weiss



News Topic: Wildfire Model Regulation

*California Dreamin' CAT Models
Into Reality*



Sept/Oct 2024

*Wildfire Model Legislation
Spreading to Colorado*



May/June 2025

*California CAT Model
Approval Underway*



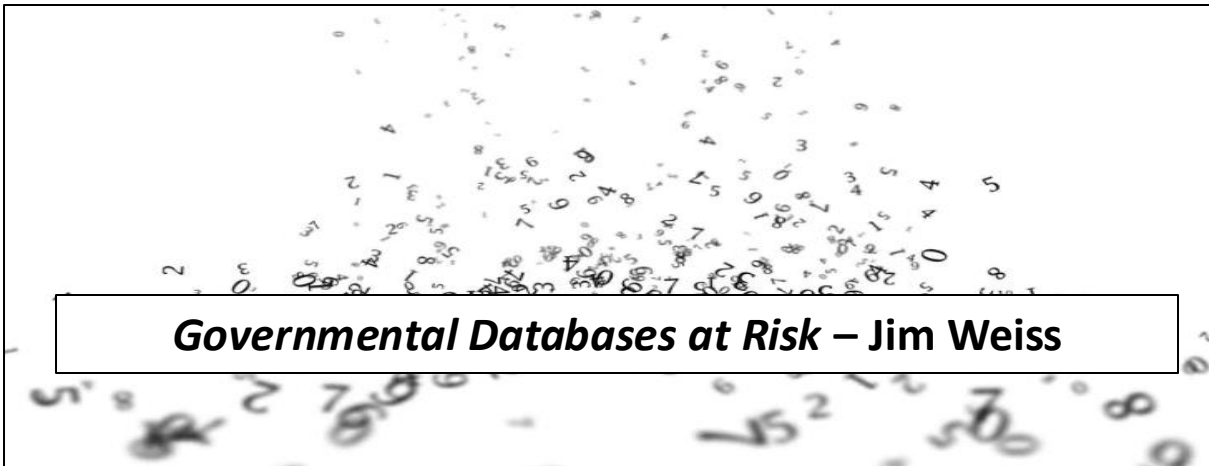
July/Aug 2025



News Topic: Governmental Policies



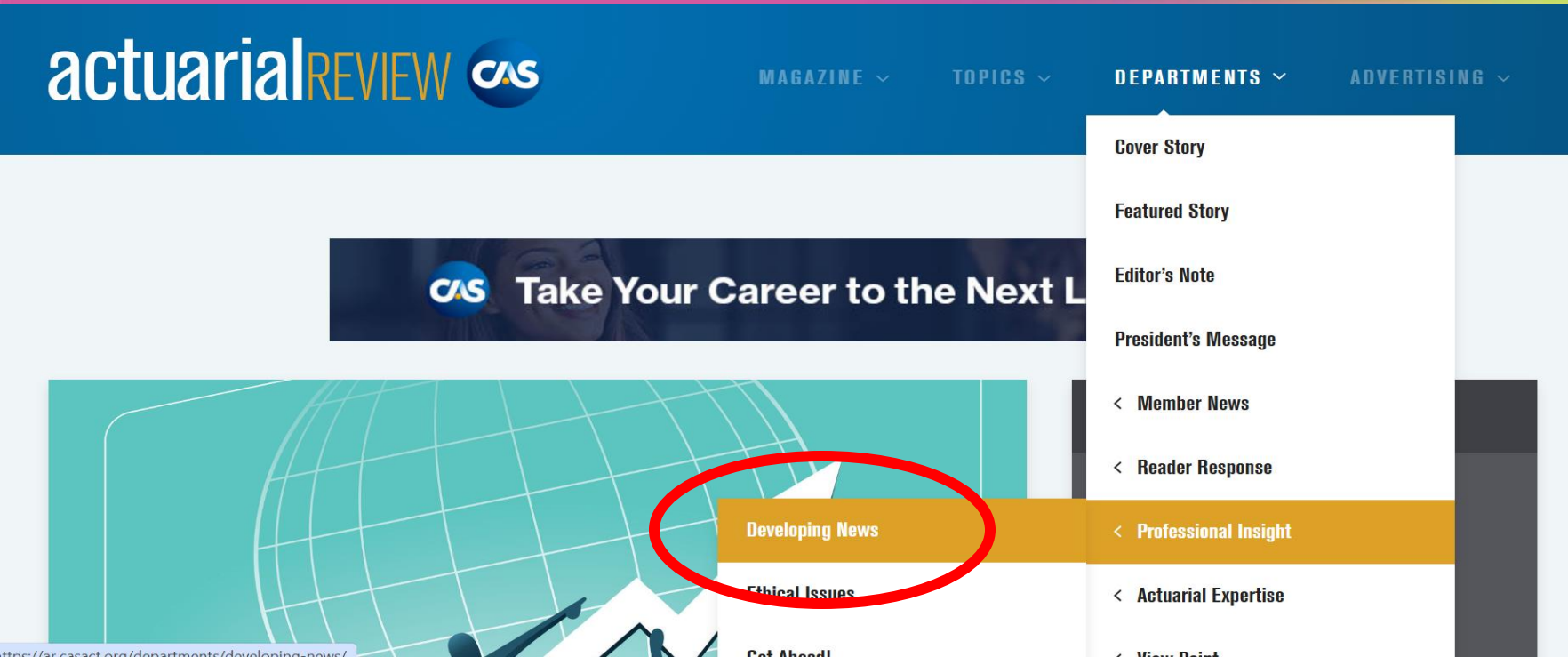
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